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This Month in Geopolitics: June 2026

Key events, themes and trends to watch in the month ahead

June 2026

Dr. Helen Belopolsky | Miha Hribernik

Deutsche Bank Research Institute

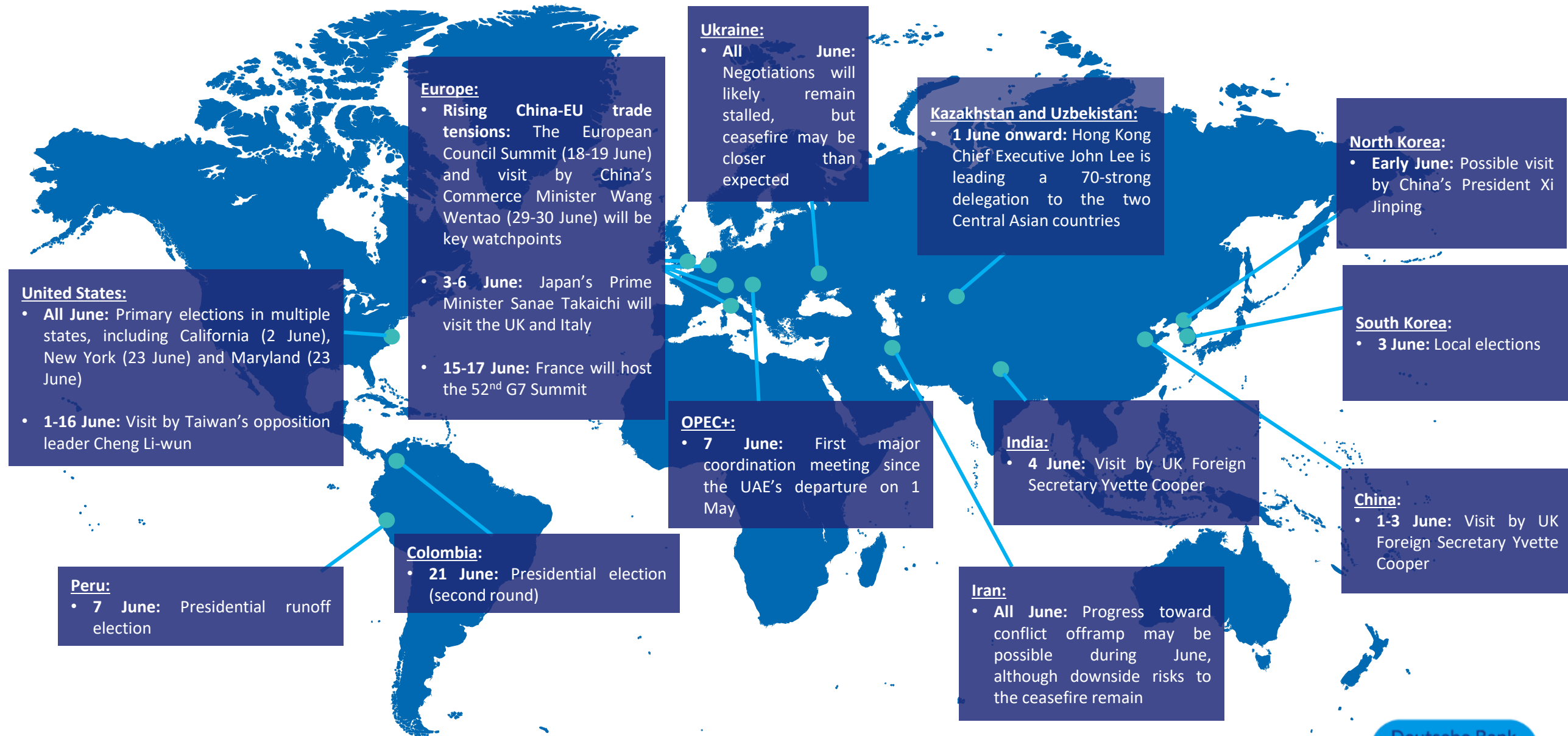
IMPORTANT RESEARCH DISCLOSURES LOCATED IN APPENDIX 1.

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At a Glance: Geopolitical events to watch in June 2026



Our monthly Look-Ahead covers a *non-exhaustive* list of key events, issues and themes to watch in the month ahead. The below map intends to serve as an executive summary, providing a list of the issues at a glance. These are covered in more detail in subsequent slides.



Source: Deutsche Bank

Key events, issues and themes to watch in June 2026

Listed in chronological order



Russia-Ukraine war

While massive strikes continue and though trilateral negotiations are stalled as a result of the war in Iran, a number of recent developments suggest we may be nearer a ceasefire than many believe. As war fatigue mounts, the rising costs of protracted conflict may eclipse its diminishing returns, shifting the strategic calculus. The US brokered a three-day ceasefire from 9-11 May, tied to Russia's Victory Day commemorations. Russian President Putin publicly said the war may be "coming to an end". Diplomatic channels remain active.

A senior Ukrainian delegation recently travelled to Washington for renewed negotiations with US officials on possible frameworks for freezing the war. The talks focused on conditions for a dignified peace according to Kyiv. President Trump had previously targeted June for a framework agreement. Reporting suggests that Washington may increase pressure on Moscow and Kyiv if negotiations remain stalled into the summer.

Iran crisis (all June)

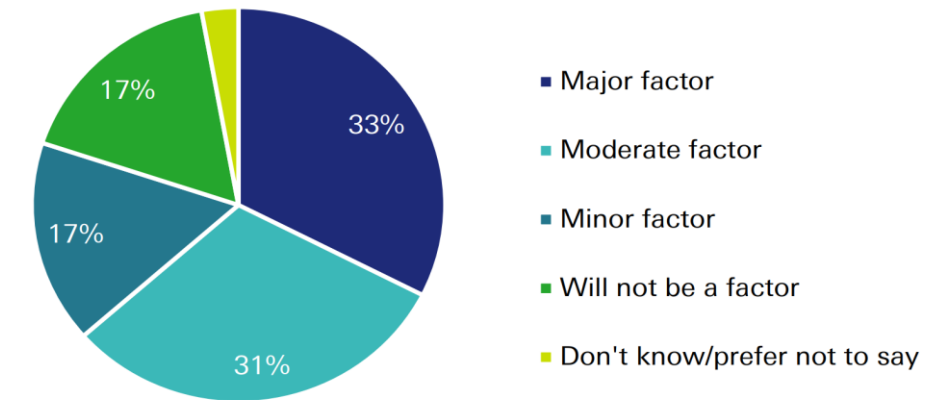
We maintain our baseline assessment that an offramp may be possible in the near term. Domestic and regional pressure on President Trump will likely continue to rise. Most US respondents in our recent polls indicated that the war in Iran and cost-of-living concerns will factor into their votes in the November midterm elections (see charts). The potential incremental benefits of the continued campaign will come up against increasing costs for the US, its allies in the region, and the global economy.

The deployment of additional military assets still provides the US with optionality to attempt to re-open the Strait of Hormuz or to raise pressure on Iran, although in our view, the likelihood of severe downside scenarios has diminished. Nevertheless, risks to the ceasefire remain, and we should expect Iran to ramp up its asymmetric tools and expand the area of conflict if fighting were to resume.

Primary elections in the US (all June)

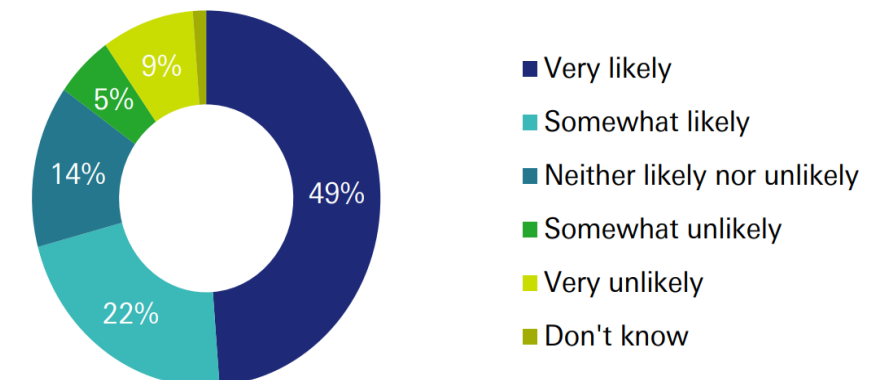
Numerous US states will hold primary elections to select candidates for the November mid-terms. Key primaries include California (2 June), New York (23 June), and Maryland (23 June). Other states with primaries include Iowa, Maine, Montana, Nevada, New Jersey, New Mexico, North Dakota, and South Dakota. Results can be an important signal of public sentiment about the current political agenda.

US participants were asked: In the upcoming midterms, to what extent will current US actions in Iran be a factor in your vote?



Source: dbDataInsights. Responses collected in April 2026 from an Online Nationally Representative sample of ~650 US respondents.

US participants were asked: How likely or unlikely is it that current cost-of-living concerns will influence your vote in the midterms?



Source: dbDataInsights. Responses collected in April 2026 from an Online Nationally Representative sample of ~650 US respondents.

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Rising China-EU trade tensions (all June)

The European Council Summit (18-19 June) and Chinese Commerce Minister Wang Wentao's visit to Brussels (29-30 June) will be key watchpoints. The EU is exploring new trade defences aimed at addressing perceived risks to EU industry from low-cost Chinese goods. European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen is expected to outline recommendations for new trade defence tools at the June summit. Beijing has warned that it could retaliate if the EU insists on new trade instruments. China's Commerce Minister Wang Wentao will reportedly visit Brussels in June for talks with EU trade chief Maroš Šefčovič in a bid to address rising tensions.

China's President Xi could visit North Korea (early June)

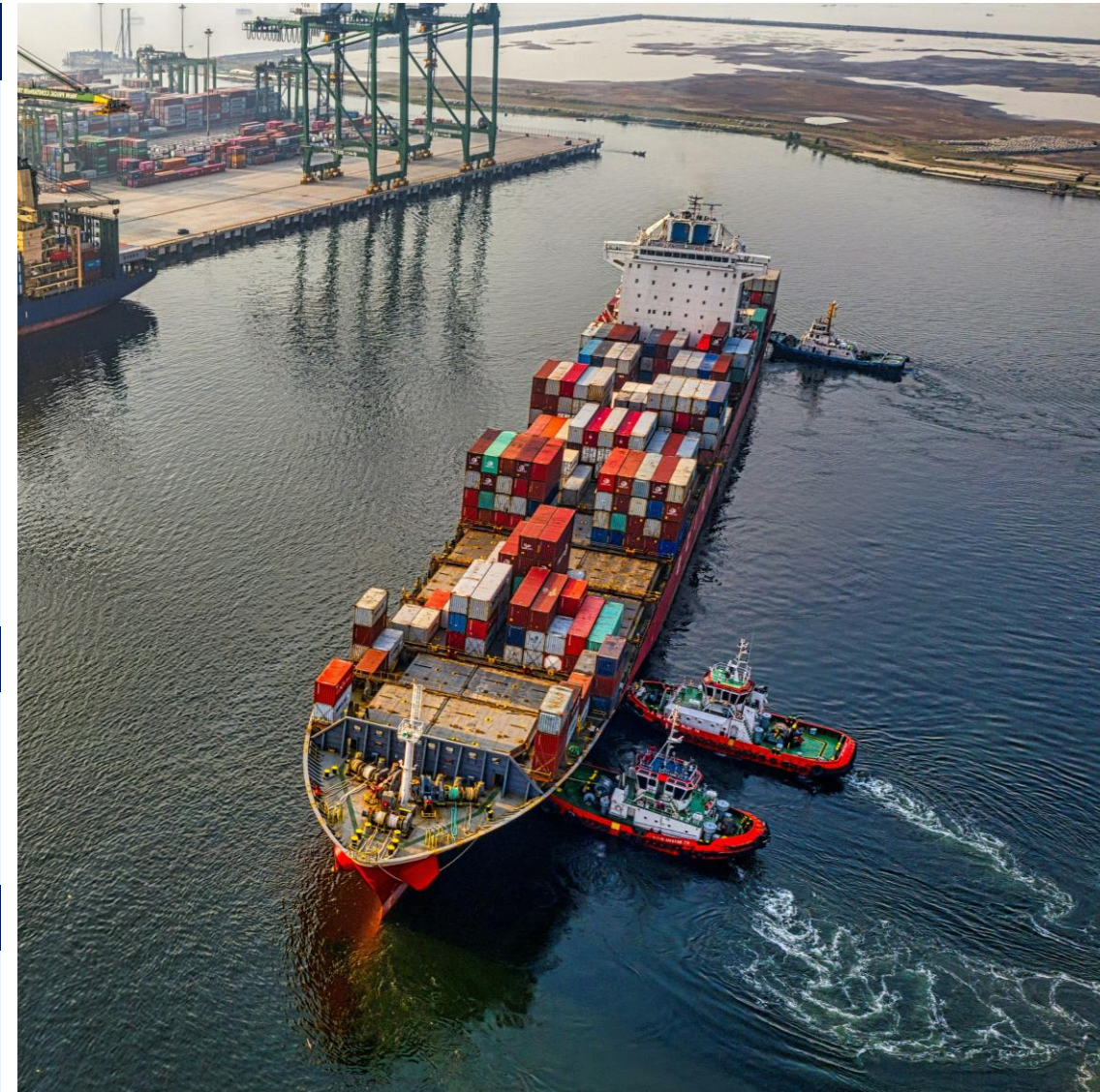
If confirmed, the visit may serve to accelerate efforts at renewed dialogue between the US and North Korea. Citing South Korean sources, media reports suggest Xi could soon visit Pyongyang, potentially to discuss bilateral ties and possibly to help revive US-North Korea talks. This is in line with our February report, which highlighted the possibility of renewed dialogue between President Trump and North Korean leader Kim Jong-un (see [North Korea: A New Strategic Calculus](#)).

UK Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper is visiting China (1-3 June) and India (4 June)

The visits likely intend to strengthen dialogue and bilateral economic cooperation. Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper's itinerary includes a stop in Beijing for talks with her Chinese counterpart Wang Yi, followed by business meetings in Shenzhen. Both sides will also hold the 11th China-UK Strategic Dialogue during the visit. Cooper will then travel to India where she will reportedly meet with her counterpart S. Jaishankar, as well as with other officials and members of the business community.

Taiwan's opposition leader Cheng Li-wun is visiting the US (1-16 June)

The visit could seek to shore up lines of communication between the opposition and Washington ahead of Taiwan's 2028 presidential election. Cheng Li-wun, the chair of Taiwan's opposition Kuomintang Party is visiting the US for meetings with officials, policymakers (including Republican and Democrat members of Congress) and academics. The visit follows in the wake of Cheng's April meeting with President Xi Jinping in Beijing, as well as ongoing [uncertainty](#) over the future of a US\$14bn arms sale package to Taiwan.



Source: [william william on Unsplash](#)

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Hong Kong delegation is visiting Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan (1 June onward)

Hong Kong's Chief Executive John Lee is heading a visit by a 70-strong delegation to the two Central Asian countries. This is reportedly the largest delegation assembled during Lee's term in office, reflecting the growing significance of Central Asia amid Hong Kong's efforts to diversify trade and investment ties. The delegation reportedly includes business representatives from both Hong Kong and mainland China.

Japan's Prime Minister Takaichi to Visit the UK and Italy (3-6 June)

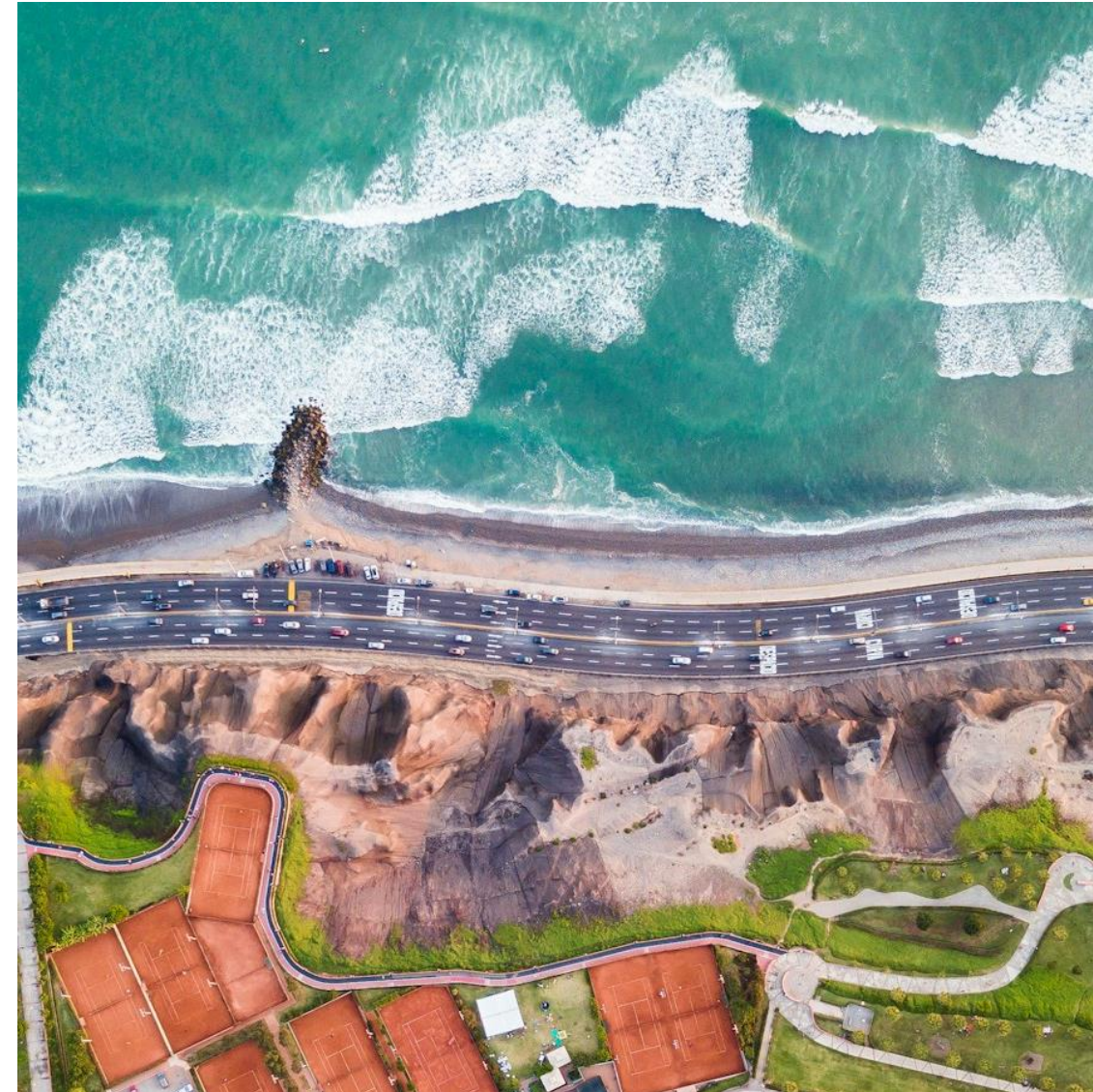
The trips are aimed at strengthening bilateral cooperation with key European partners, particularly on security and defence. The agenda reportedly includes discussions on economic security, a joint next-generation fighter jet program, Indo-Pacific security, and defence industrial cooperation. The visit reinforces a growing Japan-Europe security and technology partnership. It also signals closer coordination on economic security and supply chains.

Local elections in South Korea (3 June)

Recent polls place the ruling Democratic Party in the lead, ahead of the opposition People Power Party. The election will see 227 local governments, 4,000 local council seats and 16 mayoral and gubernatorial positions contested.

OPEC+ Ministerial Meeting (7 June)

This meeting will be particularly important given the impact of the continuing crisis in the Middle East on OPEC+ decisions. It will be the first major coordination meeting after the decision by the UAE to leave OPEC, which took effect on 1 May. The group is operating with a reduced and politically more fragmented membership. To watch will be signals on whether the remaining members can still agree on production quotas and supply discipline.



Source: [Willian Justen de Vasconcellos](#) on [Unsplash](#)

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Presidential runoff election in Peru (7 June)

The Peruvian presidential runoff election is expected to take place on 7 June, after the initial round of voting failed to produce a winner. This election is particularly significant for markets due to its potential impact on copper and mining policy, Chinese investment, fiscal policy, and constitutional reform risks. The outcome of the election could influence future foreign investment and the regulatory environment for these critical industries.

52nd G7 Summit (15-17 June)

The summit will seek to rebuild multilateral cooperation and find “points of convergence despite disagreements.” It will be hosted by French President Emmanuel Macron in Évian-les-Bains. Key themes for the summit include: continued coordination on the Russia-Ukraine war and European security, economic stability amid trade fragmentation, critical minerals and supply chain resilience, energy security and transition, and AI governance. The summit takes place against the backdrop of significant geopolitical volatility and will undertake the challenging task of finding alignment.

Presidential election in Colombia second round (21 June)

The current president, Gustavo Petro, is constitutionally ineligible for re-election, making this election a pivotal moment for Colombia's political direction. Lawyer Abelardo de la Espriella won the first round of Colombia's presidential election on 31 May, ahead of senator Iván Cepeda. Both candidates will contest the second round on 21 June. The elections are crucial for the balance of power in Latin America, given Colombia's historical role as a key US partner in security and drug trafficking, despite recent strains in the relationship under President Petro's administration.

Additionally, Colombia's stance on China's growing economic presence in the region, particularly in energy and mining, will be a significant factor shaped by the new leadership.



Source: [Arnaud Jaegers](#) on [Unsplash](#)



Appendix 1

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